

ETIS

Instructor & Course Owner Handbook

Complete teaching-staff reference for oversight, coaching, evidence interpretation, course administration, student support, and responsible use of ETIS

v0.18.1 candidate manual edition. Local UI validation only; production remains accepted v0.18.0 until protected deployment and human acceptance.

Audience	Course Owners, instructors, TAs, reviewers, and authorized teaching staff
Purpose	Enable a first-time teaching-staff member to use ETIS confidently, preserve role boundaries, coach from evidence, resolve routine student issues, and know when administrative or operational escalation is required.
Reference implementation	COMP 330/474 Software Engineering • Fall 2026
Version	v0.18.0 • October 2, 2026

CORE PRINCIPLE

Teaching staff use ETIS to observe engineering reasoning, evidence, and risk without turning activity counts, AI output, or attention signals into grades. Students remain responsible engineers; staff remain responsible educators and course authorities.

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Use Word's Navigation pane to jump directly among numbered headings. The section list below follows the same structure.

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Executive Overview

ETIS Engineering Studio gives teaching staff a view into the engineering evidence, reasoning, unresolved risk, and review activity that sit behind student project work. The instructor experience is intentionally different from the student experience: staff observe, coach, administer authorized course state, and validate selected findings; they do not impersonate student review actions or convert telemetry into grades.

What this guide enables

- Orient quickly to section health and teams that need attention.
- Move from a class-level signal to Team Detail, Engineering Evidence, and persisted review conversations.
- Interpret coverage, findings, active reviews, and AI telemetry without over-reading them.
- Manage roster/team membership only when your role permits it and preserve historical context.
- Reset repository onboarding only as a bounded recovery action.
- Understand Course Owner, Instructor, TA, and Reviewer boundaries.
- Support students with repository, review, evidence, and history questions.
- Escalate platform/auth/database incidents to the operational runbook rather than trying to solve infrastructure from the course UI.

Normal teaching-staff path

Choose section	Scan Command Center	Inspect team	Read evidence	Review persisted reasoning	Coach / administer	Recheck
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DESIGN BOUNDARY

ETIS will not autonomously assign a final grade, rank students by activity, invent repository evidence, expose private unsent student drafts, or give students a hidden “correct” engineering decision.

ABOUT THE SCREENSHOTS

Embedded screenshots are historical August 2026 examples. They illustrate workflow states; labels/layout may differ from v0.18.0. Current instructions and source contracts govern behavior. No screenshot is proof of this release’s deployment acceptance.

2. Teaching-staff roles and authority boundaries

Authentication and authorization are separate. Signing in proves identity; database-backed course/term/section state determines what a staff member may read or change. Role authority is intentionally scoped so a broad read role cannot silently become an administrative or student-action role.

Role	Typical authority	Explicit boundary
Course Owner	Term lifecycle, elevated staff assignment, semester setup, section administration, bounded repository reset, historical read.	Not a global application superuser; archived assignment does not create unrelated current authority.

Role	Typical authority	Explicit boundary
Instructor	Assigned-section administration, roster/team operations, bounded repository reset, evidence/review oversight, historical read where permitted.	Authority is section/term scoped.
TA	Active-semester bounded read/review visibility and coaching support.	No roster mutation, term lifecycle control, elevated staff assignment, repository reset, or archived authority.
Reviewer	Active-semester bounded read/review visibility.	No course administration and no archived authority.
Student	Own active course/team context and own review actions.	Cannot use staff read authority or replace verified repository directly.

READ IS NOT ACT

Seeing a persisted student review does not grant permission to answer as the student, change the student's recommendation, or continue the student's review. If a staff screen exposes student mutation actions, treat that as a defect.

3. First sign-in, navigation, and section context

1. Open the production Studio and sign in with Loyola Microsoft identity.
2. Confirm your role in the upper-right identity area and open Command Center.
3. Use the SECTION selector to choose All sections for broad read-oriented orientation or one section when making section-scoped decisions.
4. Use browser Back/Forward for meaningful navigation; the server still rechecks authorization at protected actions.
5. Use Help & guidance whenever a teaching-staff surface is unfamiliar.

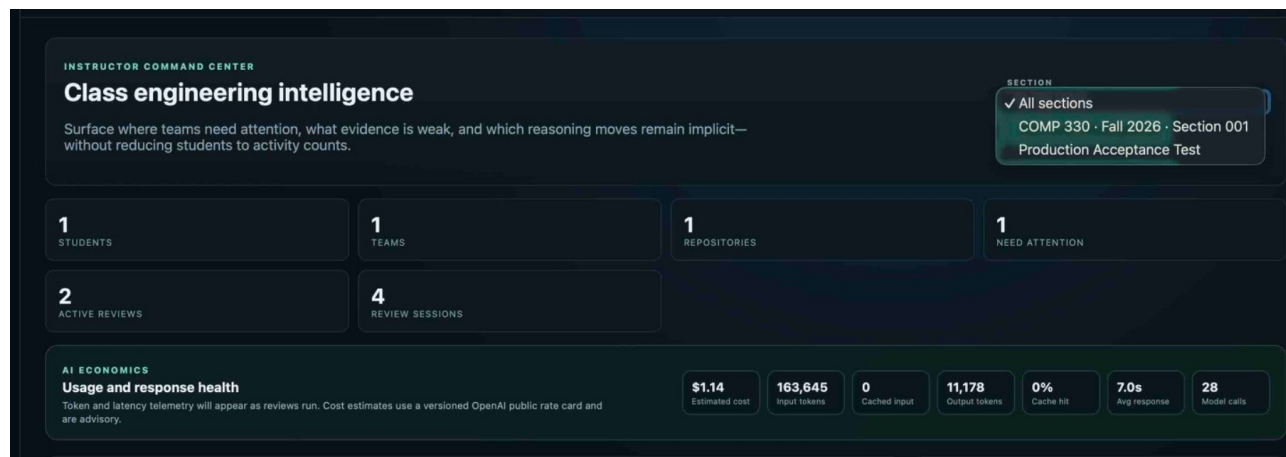


Figure 1. The section selector makes teaching context explicit. Use a specific section before administrative decisions. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

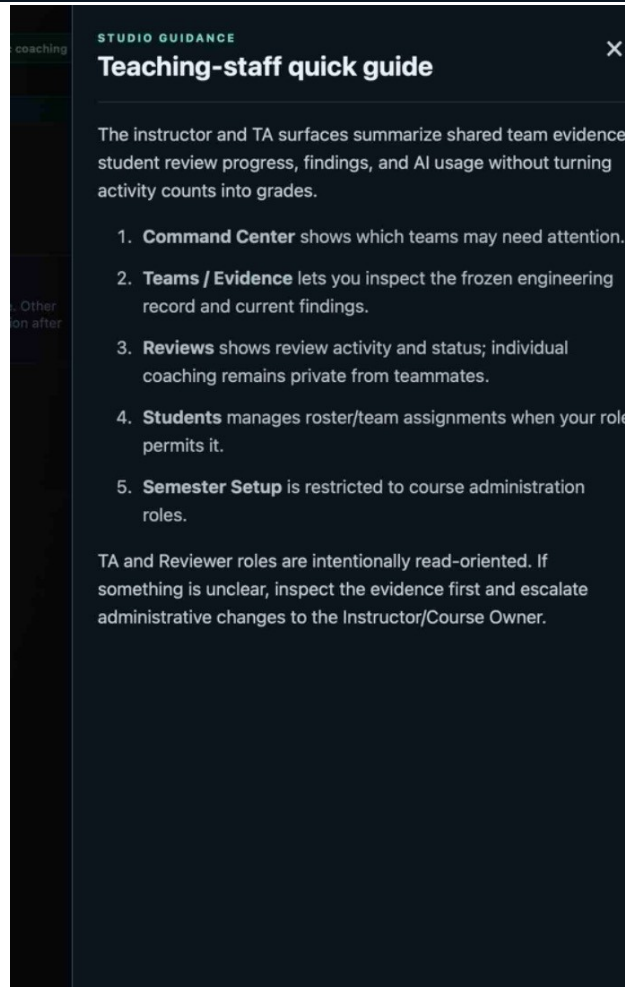


Figure 2. Teaching-staff quick guide: Command Center for attention, Teams/Evidence for shared engineering state, Reviews for persisted conversations, Students for roster/team changes, and Semester Setup for administrative roles. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

SECTION CONTEXT

"All sections" is useful for orientation and aggregated read views. Before changing roster, team, schedule, staff, or other section-scoped state, confirm the intended section explicitly.

4. Instructor Command Center

The Command Center is a triage surface, not a gradebook. Its job is to answer: Where should I look next? It combines section/team counts, active reviews, AI economics, attention signals, and Team Detail context.

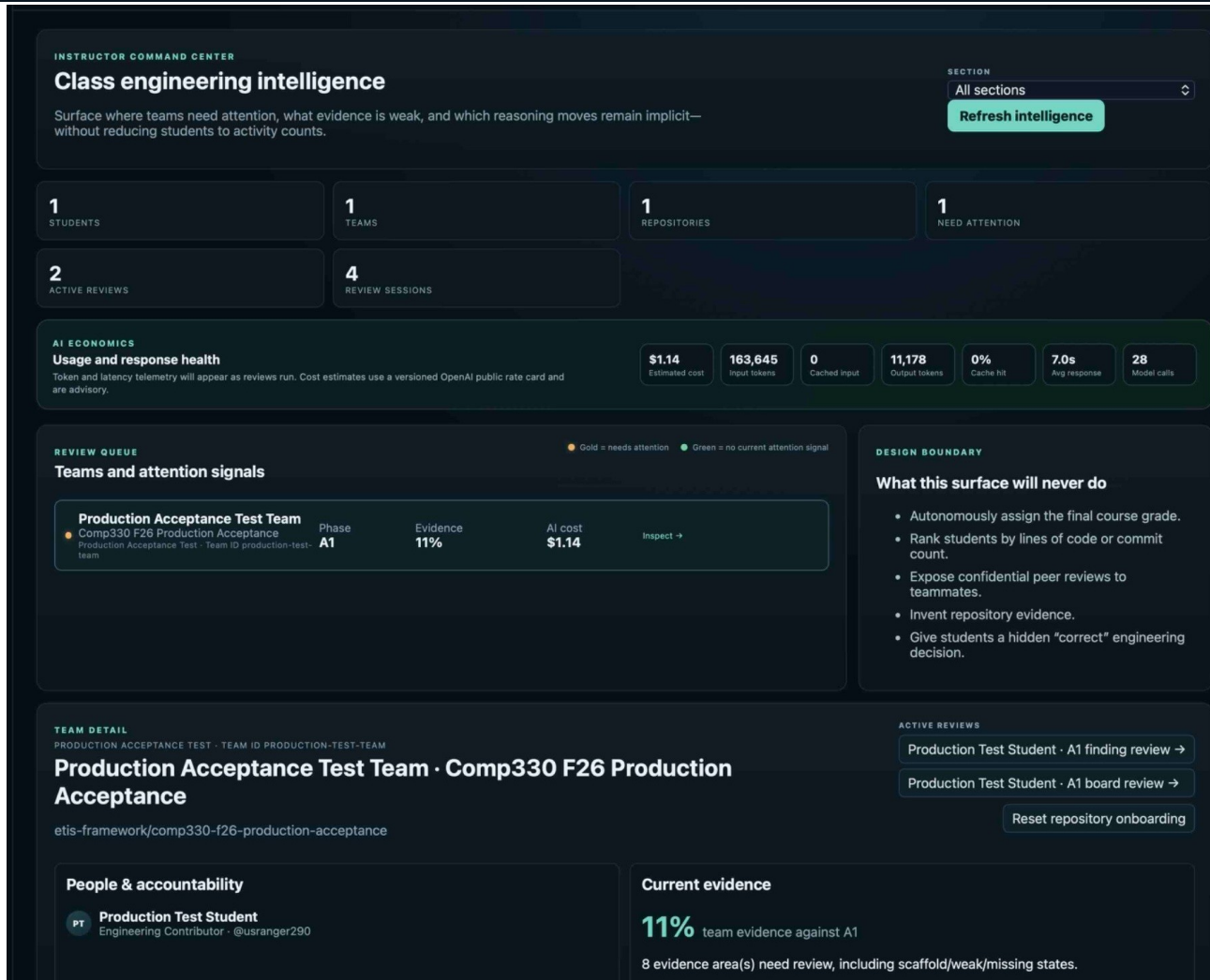


Figure 3. Instructor Command Center. The gold attention signal means “inspect,” not “student failed.” The same surface exposes Team Detail and active reviews. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Signal	Interpretation	Next move
Need attention	One or more evidence/reasoning conditions cross an attention threshold.	Inspect the team; do not infer a grade.
Evidence coverage	How much current-phase evidence is present/equivalent in the frozen/latest snapshot context.	Open Engineering Evidence; distinguish scaffold, missing, equivalent, and project-specific work.
Active reviews	Students currently have live Studio sessions.	Useful context; an active review is not itself a problem.
AI cost / latency	Operational telemetry for model use.	Investigate abnormal patterns as stewardship, not student evaluation.
Gold / green team dot	Gold = needs attention; green = no current attention signal.	Use as triage only.

INSTRUCTOR QUESTION TO ASK

Do not ask “How much activity did this team generate?” Ask “What engineering evidence or reasoning needs my attention, and what coaching or course action is actually warranted?”

5. Teams and Team Detail

Teams is the operational inventory of repository connection, shared evidence state, review participation, and cost. Team Detail is the bridge from class-level triage into the people, repository, evidence, and active-review context for one team.



Figure 4. Teams page. Repository state, review count, AI cost, and the Inspect path are visible without exposing student-private drafts. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

- Use the human-readable team name and stable team/section context together; names can change, stable identifiers preserve continuity.
- People & accountability should list all current members, not just students who linked GitHub.
- If multiple students have active reviews, Team Detail should surface each active review separately rather than one ambiguous “open review” action.
- Current evidence is a summary. Use Engineering Evidence for detailed FACT/REVIEW inspection.
- Use Reset repository onboarding only when a verified repository truly needs replacement or re-onboarding.

6. Students: roster and team membership

The Students surface is for bounded roster and team membership operations. Changes preserve historical membership/review context instead of rewriting the past.

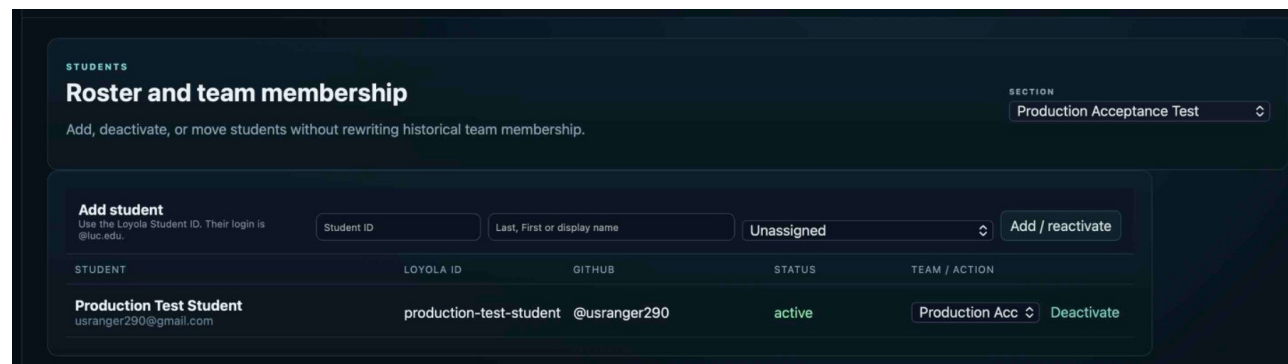


Figure 5. Students page. Authorized staff can add/reactivate, deactivate, or move students while preserving membership history. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Action	When to use it	What to preserve
Add / reactivate	A student is newly enrolled or returns after deactivation.	Use the institutional Student ID and intended team assignment.
Move team	A current student changes teams.	Preserve prior membership and review history; future authority follows current membership.
Deactivate	A student drops/leaves the section.	End current course authorization without deleting historical engineering records.
Correct wrong team	Roster is correct but team assignment is wrong.	Change the current membership; do not delete/recreate historical reviews.

ROSTER IMPORT VS. INDIVIDUAL CHANGES

Semester Setup handles section roster import. Students is the clearer surface for individual add/reactivate/deactivate/move operations during the semester. Do not use database edits to shortcut the lifecycle.

7. Reviews: viewing student engineering conversations

Reviews lists recent sessions by team/student/phase/type/status and allows authorized teaching staff to open a read-only persisted conversation. This is where you inspect how reasoning developed, not just whether a student clicked through the UI.



Figure 6. Reviews list. Each session retains phase, review type, student, status, turn count, and time context. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

REVIEWS SECTION: Production Acceptance Test

Engineering apprenticeship activity

Team evidence is shared; student conversations are private to the individual and authorized teaching staff.

Production Acceptance Test Team
Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance
 4 recent sessions · 2 active

A1 - finding review Production Test Student · active · 13 turns · 8/21/2026, 2:36:51 PM	View review →
A1 - board review Production Test Student · completed · 13 turns · 8/21/2026, 10:45:08 AM	View review →
A1 - board review Production Test Student · completed · 6 turns · 8/20/2026, 10:06:34 AM	View review →
A1 - board review Production Test Student · active · 11 turns · 8/20/2026, 7:51:36 AM	View review →

READ-ONLY REVIEW CONVERSATION [Refresh conversation](#) [Close](#)

Production Test Student · A1 board review
 Production Acceptance Test Team · Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance

Teaching-staff view only. Only persisted review turns are shown. Drafts and unsent text are not visible here.

STATUS completed	STARTED 8/21/2026, 10:45:08 AM	TURN COUNT 13 turns	LAST UPDATED 8/21/2026, 10:49:20 AM	FROZEN EVIDENCE etis-framework/comp330-f26-production-acceptance @ 194a7dc6	SNAPSHOT #2
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Maya Chen · Evidence Auditor 8/21/2026, 10:45:08 AM

Production, One thing the team has going for it: Project-specific evidence is visible in README.md. Now I want to examine one A1 concern: The supplied README identifies the repository as a CS272/COMP 272 collection of data-structures-and-algorithms modules, but it does not establish a project goal, current direction, bounded Cycle 1 vertical slice, assumptions, acceptance intent, or an evidence map for COMP 330 A1. Start with this: What should the team do now, given what the repository evidence actually supports?

Production Test Student 8/21/2026, 10:40:41 AM

work on scope?

Maya Chen · Evidence Auditor 8/21/2026, 10:45:41 AM

Yes—scope is the right immediate priority. More precisely, the team should update the durable project evidence to state the A1 goal and define a small, bounded Cycle 1 vertical slice, including its assumptions and acceptance intent. The current README supports only that this is a collection of COMP 272 modules; it doesn't yet support a specific A1 direction. What practical problem will the team or reviewer face if that scope remains unstated?

Production Test Student 8/21/2026, 10:46:17 AM

build wrong thing and or not fully meet stakeholder requirements?

Figure 7. Read-only teaching-staff review drill-down. Persisted turns and frozen evidence provenance are visible; drafts and unsent text are not. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

- Use Refresh conversation if a live session is active and you need the latest persisted turns.
- Read the frozen-evidence identifier/snapshot with the conversation; do not interpret a historical review against the team's current repository state.
- Look for evidence references, uncertainty, consequences, ownership, and whether the student can explain why a decision is defensible.
- A polished answer is not automatically stronger than an evidence-grounded disagreement or honest "I do not know yet."

PRIVACY BOUNDARY

Only persisted review turns are visible to authorized teaching staff. Unsent drafts remain private. Do not describe the review drill-down as live keystroke monitoring.

8. Engineering Evidence: FACT, REVIEW, snapshots, and longitudinal change

Engineering Evidence is the staff-facing view of frozen team evidence and change over time. It distinguishes immutable repository-derived observations (FACT) from review interpretations (REVIEW). REVIEW can be challenged/corrected without rewriting the snapshot FACT baseline.

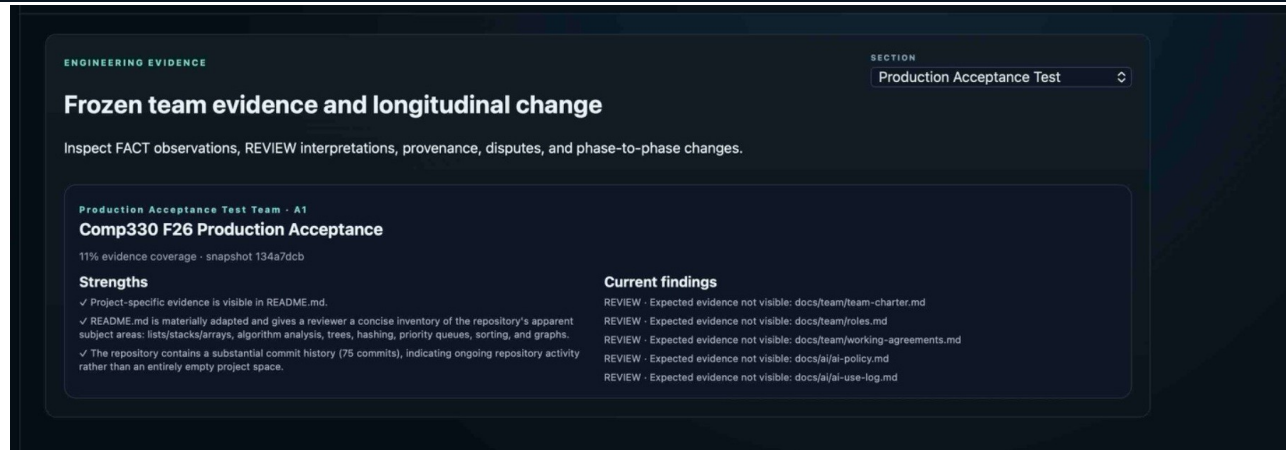


Figure 8. Instructor Engineering Evidence view. Strengths and current findings are tied to a named snapshot and current phase. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Concept	Instructor meaning
FACT	Frozen repository-derived provenance: commit/tree/artifact/workflow state. Do not rewrite it during a review.
REVIEW	Interpretation of FACT evidence: concern, strength, gap, or finding. May be challenged/corrected/dispositioned.
Snapshot	Pinned evidence state used by a review. A later repository refresh does not mutate the historical review.
Coverage	Evidence present/equivalent for the phase; starter scaffold is not completed team work.
Longitudinal change	Compare later snapshots/phase context to see what changed without overwriting earlier evidence.

0% OR LOW COVERAGE

Low coverage can mean scaffold-only, missing, weak, or project-specific evidence not yet recognized. Inspect the underlying evidence before coaching or evaluating the team.

9. Findings, disputes, and staff dispositions

A finding is a REVIEW interpretation, not immutable repository truth. Students can discuss, challenge, provide contrary evidence, accept/defer, or work toward resolution. Staff finding validation/disposition is a separate authority from generic review read access.

1. Open the relevant Engineering Evidence or review context.
2. Read the FACT provenance first.
3. Read the finding as an interpretation of that FACT baseline.
4. Consider the student's contrary evidence or correction.
5. Use explicit staff validation/disposition only when your role permits it.

6. Preserve the frozen snapshot; correct the interpretation, not the historical evidence.

Finding closure and action authorship

Only authoritative corrected or resolved findings are closed. Confirmed, evidence disputed, accepted risk and deferred findings remain open. Inspecting, searching, recommending and completing a review do not close a finding; work after the snapshot cannot close it on that earlier snapshot.

The Review Room is the conversation home. Engineering Evidence is the saved source notebook. Same-snapshot and newer-saved-snapshot notices explain their relationship; browsing newer saved evidence never changes an active review's frozen baseline.

Inspect cited source opens the attached frozen artifact. Find supporting evidence searches the frozen snapshot for equivalent evidence; it is bounded and not exhaustive. Discuss helps you understand, Challenge tests an interpretation, and Help me resolve this coaches next work. An absent source must not be replaced by a guessed file link.

Button-triggered instructions are recorded as review actions, not as words the student wrote. Unsent drafts are preserved and remain private. Optional review context and other concerns stay secondary to the current concern and conversation.

Before validating a challenge, confirm the evidence was already in the named frozen snapshot and is substantively equivalent. A reviewer concession is not sufficient lifecycle authority. Use only the explicit permitted correction/disposition path; generic staff read access cannot act as the student.

10. Repository recovery and reset

Students cannot directly replace a verified team repository. A Course Owner/Instructor reset is the bounded recovery path when the team's verified repository must legitimately change.

Repository replacement recovery

Confirm replacement is necessary	Open Team Detail	Reset repository onboarding	Historical evidence remains	Team nominates again	Owner/admin authorizes	Exact repo reverified
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WHEN TO RESET

Reset only when the verified team repository must be deliberately replaced or re-onboarded. Do not reset merely because GitHub App approval is pending, a student linked the wrong personal GitHub identity, or the team has weak evidence.

- Reset clears the current trusted repository binding/onboarding state.
- Historical frozen evidence and reviews remain preserved.
- The team returns to the normal nomination → owner/admin authorization → exact verification flow.
- Do not force-bind arbitrary repository state directly in the database.

11. AI Usage & Cost

AI Usage & Cost is operational intelligence: token volume, caching, model latency, estimated cost, and call counts. It supports stewardship and capacity/cost investigation. It is not student performance telemetry.

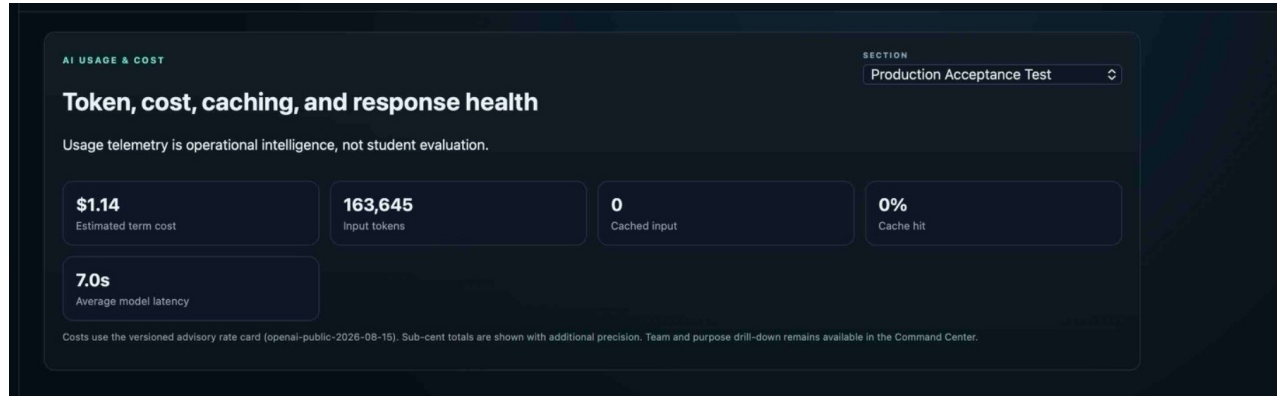


Figure 9. AI Usage & Cost. The section selector scopes telemetry; the surface explicitly states that usage telemetry is operational intelligence, not student evaluation. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Signal	Reason to investigate	Do not conclude
Estimated cost	Unexpected term/team spending or budget trajectory.	"High cost = poor student."
Input/output tokens	Very large context/response patterns.	"More tokens = more learning."
Cache hit	Operational efficiency/cost behavior.	Any academic meaning.
Model latency	User experience degradation or provider issues.	Student effort or quality.
Model calls	Unexpected automation or usage spike.	Engagement score.

12. Settings & Access

Settings & Access summarizes the identity and integration boundaries staff should understand: Loyola Microsoft SSO authenticates the human; GitHub identity linking identifies the engineer; GitHub App repository authorization grants bounded repository evidence access; ETIS maintains no local production passwords.

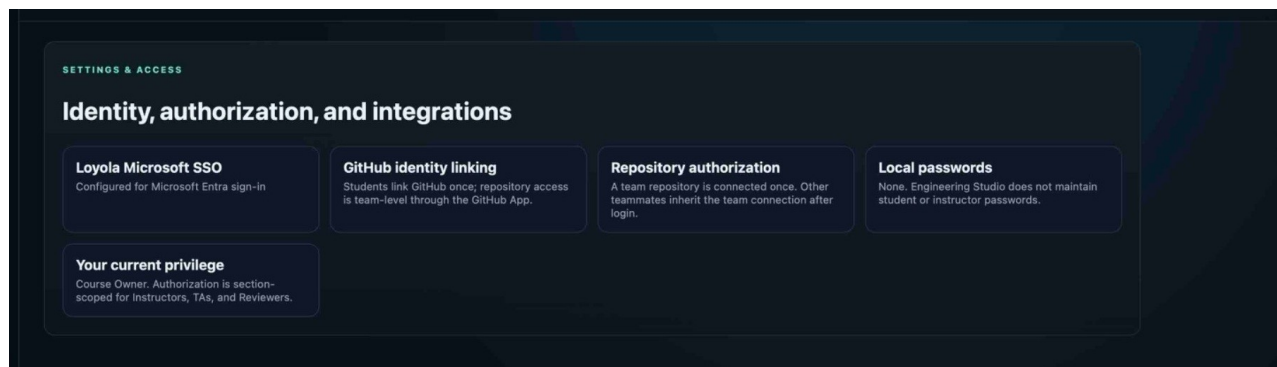


Figure 10. Settings & Access. The current privilege card helps staff confirm their authority posture without exposing secrets. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

IDENTITY IS NOT AUTHORITY

A successful Microsoft sign-in does not itself grant instructor authority. A linked GitHub identity does not grant repository administration. Repository App access does not grant course authority. Keep these boundaries separate when troubleshooting.

13. Using ETIS as a coaching instrument, not a grader

Better teaching question	Avoid
What evidence supports the student's recommendation?	How many review turns did they generate?
What uncertainty did they identify and how would they reduce it?	Did they agree with the reviewer?
What consequence or residual risk did they own?	Did the AI mark it green?
Can they challenge a bad finding with evidence?	Did they accept every finding?
What changed between snapshots and why?	Did evidence coverage reach a magic percentage?

ACADEMIC AUTHORITY

ETIS supports instructor judgment; it does not replace it. Sakai/course policy remains authoritative for deadlines, submissions, grading, and academic decisions.

14. Daily and weekly instructor operating rhythm

Lightweight operating rhythm

Before class: status/known issues	Scan Command Center	Inspect gold teams	Open evidence/reviews	Coach or administer only as needed	Recheck after team changes
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Cadence	Recommended use
Before a class/project work session	Scan Command Center and any known operational notices. Confirm students are not blocked by roster/repository issues.
Weekly	Review teams needing attention, unresolved findings, evidence movement, and abnormal cost/latency.
Before a phase transition	Confirm release/calendar state, repository readiness, evidence context, and course instructions in Sakai.
After a student support incident	Confirm the underlying state changed as intended; preserve historical records.

Cadence	Recommended use
After production deployment	Operations owner runs production acceptance; instructor need not manually inspect Azure if acceptance is green.

15. Supporting common student situations

Student report	Instructor response
"I can sign in but cannot enter."	Check active roster/section enrollment. Authentication is not course authorization.
"I am on the wrong team."	Correct current membership through Students; preserve prior membership/review history.
"GitHub says approval is required."	Determine repository ownership. Organization owner/admin may need to approve; do not call it instructor approval unless you have GitHub organization authority.
"We linked the wrong GitHub account."	Student uses Change linked GitHub account. Do not reset verified repo solely for a personal identity relink.
"Our verified repo is actually wrong."	Use bounded repository reset, then have team repeat normal onboarding.
"The finding is wrong."	Have the student challenge it with evidence; use Review Findings. Staff can validate/disposition when appropriate.
"Evidence says 0%."	Inspect whether repository is scaffold-only, genuinely missing evidence, or uses project-specific equivalents.
"Studio is slow/down."	Move to the production operations runbook; capture time, section/team, route/screen, and request/browser evidence if available.

16. Teaching-staff troubleshooting

Symptom	First check	Next action
Wrong/missing section	SECTION selector + staff assignment	Confirm SectionStaff/course role for active term.
Cannot mutate roster/team	Current role	TA/Reviewer are read-oriented; Instructor/Course Owner required.
Archived term appears writable	Term state	Treat as blocker; archived is historical/read-only.

Symptom	First check	Next action
Review conversation missing student draft	Expected privacy behavior	Only persisted turns are intentionally visible.
Review seems tied to old evidence	Snapshot identifier/date	Historical review remains pinned; inspect newer snapshot/review separately.
Team attention signal surprising	Team Detail + Engineering Evidence	Inspect underlying evidence/reasoning; do not infer grade.
Repository reset unavailable	Role/section context	Confirm Instructor/Course Owner authority and active term.
AI cost spike	AI Usage & Cost + operations telemetry	Investigate usage pattern/provider cost; do not treat as academic signal.
Health OK but user cannot access	Roster/authorization/auth path	Differentiate service health from identity/course authorization.

Current release teaching checks

The v0.18.0 source version is defined in apps/api/app/version.py. FastAPI/OpenAPI and /health use that value. Source version, merged Git SHA, immutable image/revision, deployment success and production acceptance are separate evidence. The August GO records and v0.17 analytical history keep their original dates and versions.

Accepted production uses shadow/shadow evaluation with legacy student-visible authority. Shadow validator/planner/selector/realizer evaluation remains internal and does not replace student-visible authority. This release introduces no PR5 authority transfer, database migration or course-model change.

In Help, artifact, challenge and exit dialogs, Tab and Shift+Tab stay within the dialog, Escape dismisses through the existing close action, and focus returns to a usable opener. Escape does not finish a review. Closing a pending challenge does not cancel its submitted request.

Support students with a clear next action, not a requirement to accept every finding. Weak evidence, fluent prose and strong repositories all require contextual interpretation; the absence of high-priority findings does not end useful engineering tradeoff coaching.

17. Appendix A - Role authority matrix

Capability	Course Owner	Instructor	TA	Reviewer
Read active section/team/evidence	Yes	Assigned	Bounded	Bounded
Read persisted reviews	Yes	Assigned	Bounded	Bounded
Roster/team mutation	Yes	Assigned	No	No
Repository reset	Yes	Assigned	No	No

Capability	Course Owner	Instructor	TA	Reviewer
Term lifecycle	Yes	No unless Course Owner	No	No
Assign elevated staff	Yes	No	No	No
Archived historical read	Yes	Assigned where permitted	No	No
Act as student in review	No	No	No	No

18. Appendix B - Instructor use cases

Use case: a team is gold on Command Center

1. Inspect Team Detail.
2. Open Engineering Evidence and identify the actual weak/missing/scaffold state.
3. Open relevant persisted review if reasoning context matters.
4. Decide whether coaching, course clarification, or no intervention is appropriate.
5. Recheck after the team makes evidence changes/new reviews.

Use case: student moved teams mid-semester

1. Change current team membership through Students.
2. Verify new current access.
3. Do not delete old review history or membership events.
4. Use historical context carefully: old reviews remain associated with the earlier team/evidence state.

Use case: repository must be replaced

1. Confirm the verified repository is truly wrong.
2. Use Reset repository onboarding.
3. Confirm old snapshots/reviews remain.
4. Have team nominate the new repository.
5. Owner/admin authorizes selected-repository access.
6. Team completes exact verification.

Use case: student challenges a finding

1. Read the frozen FACT evidence.
2. Read the finding as REVIEW interpretation.
3. Evaluate the student's contrary evidence.
4. If correction is valid, use the authorized disposition/correction path rather than rewriting FACT.

19. Appendix C - First-week checklist

- Confirm the term is Active and correct sections exist.

- Confirm your role and section selector behavior.
- Confirm roster and team assignments.
- Confirm each team has the intended repository onboarding path.
- Confirm students can sign in with Loyola identity and normal Loyola MFA.
- Confirm at least one instructor can inspect Teams, Reviews, Engineering Evidence, and Students.
- Explain to students that Studio is developmental and evidence-grounded, not grading AI.
- Explain GitHub owner/admin authorization vs instructor authority.
- Know where the production operations runbook lives before class.

20. Appendix D - Terminology

Term	Meaning
Attention signal	Triage indicator that a team may warrant inspection; not a grade.
FACT	Frozen repository-derived evidence/provenance.
REVIEW	Interpretation of FACT evidence; challengeable/correctable.
Snapshot	Pinned evidence state used by a review.
Persisted turn	Student/reviewer message actually submitted and stored; visible to authorized staff.
Unsent draft	Private student text not submitted/persisted; not visible to staff.
Repository reset	Bounded instructor/course-owner recovery action returning team to normal onboarding.
Section	Course offering context within a term; shared context for roster, teams, release schedule, and staff.
Archived	Historical/read-only term state; normal student operational access ends.

Instructor support for the revised student experience — v0.18.1 candidate

Coach students on the two rooms

Ask the student to identify Engineering Review Room (conversation with the Review Board) and Engineering Evidence Room (saved evidence notebook). Have them switch rooms and return without finishing their session.

Coach on cumulative reviews

Explain that a student may have many open Board Review sessions but views only one at a time. Review History includes open sessions to resume and finished conversations to inspect read-only. Finishing a review does not accept a phase gate or erase evidence.

Support Sam's stale-snapshot scenario

Have the student read the selected review's commit, phase and snapshot identifier; compare it with Evidence Room. After changing, committing and pushing work, choose Start another Board Review. If the commit/phase have not changed, the new review may reuse saved evidence. Never claim later changes were part of the old FACT.

Troubleshooting

First confirm GitHub identity linked versus team repository verified—these are independent checks. For a failed start, inspect Review History before retrying. For drafts, return to the original session and browser tab; do not assume unsent student text is persisted server-side.

Staff governance

Lack of attributed activity does not establish nonparticipation; instructor owns participation verification, individual assessment, and grades. Shadow analytical modes do not grant new authority.